

tool which gave you the ability to backup the whole computer or selected files or drives. To access this backup utility, click Start and then click Run. Type 'ntbackup.exe' in the Open box and click ok. The Backup utility opens up in wizard mode.

Windows 7

Windows 7 came with a much more refined tool for backup than Windows XP. Using this tool you can backup specific files and folders and also create a system image if you want. For those who don't know what to back up you can let the tool chose for you. To access this backup utility, click the Start button, and then click Control Panel. In the Control Panel, click Backup and Restore. The backup and restore utility opens up. From here you can either create a backup, restore from a backup, create a system image or create a system repair disk.

Windows 8 & 8.1

Windows 8 & 8.1 has a nice new backup and recovery tool called File History. It allows for easy automated backup of your data and on a number of devices. To access this utility, go to Control Panel and click on System and Security. In this click on File History and the tool will open. Simply select the backup destination and click the "Turn on" button on the page to get started with the backup.

Backing up using 3rd party software

The best part is that a lot of good backup software is free. Backups can be of two types, offline backup where the backup medium is another physical storage medium and the second, online backup where the data is backed up to the cloud which can then be downloaded from anywhere.

Offline tools

Let us take a look at a few offline backup software that are currently making the rounds.

Genie Timeline

The first thing you are going to notice about Genie Timeline is its immense simplicity. You can simply set it and forget it, no need of continuous monitoring of the tool. The setup wizard is just a two step process to starting up your backup. First, you simply select the storage option where you want to keep the backup and next, you select what you want to backup. Genie Timeline makes it very simple for the novice user to select what they want to